

The Phishing Story, Explained Simply

What we built for Step 5, and how it works — no tricky words.

What is this thing we built?

Imagine a picture book that tells the story of a trick someone plays on you. Each page shows one part of the trick. You can flip forward and backward through the pages with buttons, just like turning pages in a real book.

Nothing in this story is real. We made up a pretend company called **"SecurePay"** just for the story, so we're not copying any real company. And nothing you type or click here is ever saved or sent anywhere — it's just a safe, pretend story to learn from.

Before the story: a shelf of books

Before you open the Phishing story, there's a shelf with six book covers on it — Phishing, Ransomware, Fake Wi-Fi, and a few others. Only the Phishing book can be opened right now. The other five have a little "Coming soon" sticker on them because nobody's written them yet.

The six pages of the story

1 The Bait

A bad guy writes a pretend letter. He says he's from "SecurePay," which sounds like a company you could trust — but the address he's actually sending it from is fake and made-up.

2 It Lands

The letter shows up in a mailbox next to other, real letters. It doesn't look scary or weird at all — it just looks like one more letter in the pile.

3 The Hook

You open the letter. It says "Hurry! You only have 24 hours!" That's the bad guy trying to make you panic, so you click without stopping to think first.

4 The Trap

You click the button. It takes you to a page that *looks* exactly like SecurePay's real website. But look closely at the address at the top — it says something different. That's the one clue that gives it away.

5 The Catch

You type in your username and password. The second you press "Log In," the bad guy now has your password. Then it pretends to send you along to the real website, so you don't notice anything went wrong.

6 The Damage

Two boxes side by side: one shows the bad things that happen next, the other shows what you should have done instead — like checking the real address before typing your password anywhere.

How you flip through the pages

There are "Previous" and "Next" buttons at the bottom, just like turning pages in a book. There are also six little number bubbles above the story (1 through 6) — you can tap any bubble to jump straight to that page, instead of flipping through one at a time.

When you turn a page, it fades in gently instead of just popping into place — like a soft page turn instead of a slap. But if someone's computer is set to "reduce motion" (because moving pictures make some people feel dizzy or sick), the page just switches instantly instead, with no fading at all. You can also flip pages using the arrow keys on a keyboard, once you've clicked on a button first.

Two mistakes we found — and fixed

Mistake 1: Fast clicking got confused.

At first, if you clicked "Next" really, really fast three times in a row, the book only turned one page instead of three — like it got confused about which page you were actually supposed to be on. We fixed it so the book always knows the right page, no matter how fast you click.

Mistake 2: The number bubbles ignored the keyboard.

At first, the little number bubbles could only be tapped with a mouse — someone using only a keyboard (or someone who can't see the screen and uses a special reading tool) couldn't press them at all. That's not fair. We turned the bubbles into real buttons, so now anyone can use them, mouse or keyboard.

We only know about these two mistakes because we tested the story ourselves first — clicking fast on purpose, and trying to use only a keyboard on purpose — before saying it was finished.